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News

Audrey Clement says she is again running for County Board, on an anti-Missing Middle platform

By **ARLnow.com**

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County Board candidate Audrey Clement in Virginia Square on Election Day — Nov. 7, 2022 (staff photo by Jay Westcott)

Audrey Clement is again tossing her hat in the ring for the upcoming Arlington County Board race.

Clement said in an email to supporters this morning that she is planning to run as an independent in the race, which will fill the seats of Chair Christian Dorsey and member Katie Cristol, who are not seeking reelection.

The repeat candidate, who has unsuccessfully run for various offices in Arlington nearly a dozen times since her [first County Board race in 2011](#), won a few northern Arlington precincts in the Board general election [this past fall](#). Clement says she will again run with her opposition to [“Missing Middle” housing rezoning](#) front and center.

This morning’s announcement is below.

[I'm Audrey Clement, the Independent candidate for Arlington County Board.](#) As a 19-year Westover resident, long time civic activist, and past member of the Transportation Commission, I'm running for County Board because the County has pushed harmful policies resulting in:

- overcrowded schools
- gentrification
- loss of green space
- excessive runoff, and
- a 10 year average annual effective tax rate increase that is almost twice the rate of inflation

[I also oppose the so-called "Enhanced Housing Options \(EHO\)" a/k/a "Missing Middle" ordinance that the County rammed through on March 22, 2023.](#) [Missing Middle](#) up-zoned single family neighborhoods throughout the county, despite massive opposition from homeowners and those like myself who believe it is nothing more than a concession to developers.

While two of the other contenders for County Board have also recently spoken out against Missing Middle, I've been vocal in my opposition to it since long before it was popular to speak out — [February 22, 2020 to be exact.](#)

Other County Board contenders are pushing for Missing Middle, while actively misleading voters about what it will do. They claim that Missing Middle will end de facto redlining even though [in a February 1 letter to County Board, the local NAACP president reported that only 20% of Blacks in the county can afford to buy or rent a Missing Middle unit](#) (p.3).

These County Board candidates also say that Missing Middle will provide a way for moderate income residents to get starter homes, even though most of the units will be rental.

At the March 28, 2023 annual budget hearing, [Alice Hogan, a board member of Arlington Partnership for Affordable Housing \(APAH\)](#), [stated that Missing Middle will not meet the needs of anyone earning less than area median income](#), [33:23 8:00:02] which is about [\\$123,000 per year](#). Hogan and other Missing Middle proponents used this fact to lobby for more housing subsidies at the hearing. This sounds like they are gearing up to push for taxpayer subsidies of Missing Middle units to make them affordable.

If you object to subsidizing overpriced housing and the constant misleading hype about the supposed benefits of Missing Middle, then you should vote for Clement for County Board on November 7, 2023.

If elected, I pledge to:

- Seek immediate tax relief for residents and businesses.
- Demand full transparency in the deals the County cuts with developers.
- Preserve Arlington's cultural heritage. Stop permitting the destruction of historic structures.
- Save our parks, streams and tree canopy. Stop clearcutting wooded areas on public property.
- Say YES to real social justice reforms and NO to symbolic gestures.

If you share my agenda, then:

- Spread the word about my candidacy.
- Donate to my campaign.
- Help make the "Arlington Way" more than an empty phrase.

Sincerely,

Audrey Clement, Ph.D.

[Independent Candidate](#)

Clement will face the two Democratic candidates who emerge from the party’s primary in June. Democrats will utilize ranked-choice voting to choose among the announced candidates of Maureen Coffey, Jonathan Dromgoole, Natalie Roy, Julius “JD” Spain, Tony Weaver, and Susan Cunningham.

Roy and Cunningham have also expressed degrees of opposition to the Missing Middle changes.

About the Author



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